

Hilscher-Clarke Electric — Engagement Plan

Prepared by: Vanderpool Consulting

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Engagement Summary

Vanderpool Consulting has been retained to design, build, and deploy a learning and development system for Hilscher-Clarke Electric, a fast-growing commercial/industrial electrical contractor. The engagement runs from March through August 2026, coinciding with the company's planned separation from GiANT (leadership development provider) on August 31. The work covers curriculum architecture, information architecture, change management, and the delivery of training content via Canvas LMS using SCORM packages.

Phase 1: Discovery & Architecture (March–May 2026)

Capacity: 5 hours/week

1.1 — GiANT Audit & Catalog (Weeks 1–7, wrap-up in Week 8)

This is the highest-priority work and runs the full length of Phase 1. Before anything new is designed, we need a complete picture of how deeply GiANT is embedded in the organization — not just what content exists, but where it lives in people's thinking, language, workflows, and decision-making. The audit is detailed in a separate plan document ('GiANT_Audit_Plan_v0.2.md') and follows five sub-phases:

1. ****Content Inventory (Weeks 1–3)**** — Request and catalog every piece of GiANT content, tool, assessment, and framework in use. Each item is documented with ownership status, licensing, usage patterns, and dependencies.
2. ****Integration Mapping (Weeks 3–4)**** — Document where GiANT shows up in the employee lifecycle (hiring, onboarding, reviews, promotions) and operational workflows (project kickoffs, coaching, leadership meetings). Includes a language and culture audit to identify GiANT vocabulary that has become HC vocabulary.
3. ****Stakeholder Interviews (Weeks 4–6)**** — Structured interviews with 3–4 senior leaders (45 min each) and 4–6 managers/superintendents (30 min each) covering day-to-day usage, perceived value, Five Voices adoption, and transition concerns.
4. ****Dependency & Risk Assessment (Weeks 6–7)**** — Categorize risks as hard breaks (September 1 impact), soft breaks (gradual degradation), and invisible dependencies. Rate by severity, urgency, and mitigation path.
5. ****Retain / Replace / Retire Recommendations (Week 7 + Week 8 wrap-up)**** — Every GiANT item and integration point gets a disposition. Week 8 (first 20 hr/week) is used to finalize all deliverables, build the executive summary, and present findings to Jessica Hart and Eric Ward.

Deliverables:

- GiANT Content Inventory — structured catalog of all GiANT materials with ownership, licensing, and usage data
- GiANT Touchpoint Map — where GiANT appears in employee lifecycle and operations, including language/culture audit
- Interview Synthesis — themes and findings from 7–10 stakeholder interviews
- Dependency & Risk Assessment — what breaks on August 31, rated by severity and urgency
- Retention & Evolution Recommendations — retain/replace/retire disposition for every item, executive summary, and prioritized action list for Phase 2

Total audit allocation: 55 hours (35 hrs across Weeks 1–7 at 5 hrs/week + 20 hrs in Week 8 wrap-up)

1.2 — Curriculum Architecture & Information Architecture (Weeks 3–6)

This is the structural backbone of the entire engagement. The curriculum architecture defines how learning content is organized, categorized, and discovered. The information architecture defines how that content (and all supporting materials) is stored, named, permissioned, and governed. We design them as a single integrated system so that new content automatically lands in the right place and legacy content can be migrated incrementally.

Curriculum Architecture Deliverables:

- Training Domain Map — the four-layer model with defined boundaries:
 - Layer 1: Safety & Compliance (mandated, non-negotiable)
 - Layer 2: Skills & Trade (equipment, technical procedures, certifications)
 - Layer 3: Management (project management, people management, scenario-based)
 - Layer 4: Leadership (organizational leadership, culture, strategic thinking)
- Role-to-Curriculum Matrix — maps each organizational role (from the org chart) to required and recommended training across all four layers, identifying which content is mandatory vs. elective at each career stage
- Learning Path Templates — structured sequences for common development tracks: new hire onboarding, first-time superintendent, project manager development, leadership pipeline
- Content Type Taxonomy — defines the standard learning object types and when to use each: course, module, lesson, assessment, job aid, reference guide, scenario exercise, spaced repetition item

Information Architecture Deliverables:

- Naming Convention Standard — a consistent, human-readable and machine-sortable taxonomy for all files and learning objects. Format: `[Domain]-[Level]-[Type]-[Identifier]-[Version]`. Example: `SAF-L1-MOD-confined-space-entry-v2.1`. Codes map to domains, roles, and levels so that any file can be located, categorized, and reported on without opening it.
- Folder Structure & Storage Map — a Google Drive architecture that mirrors the curriculum hierarchy:
 - Top level: Domain folders (Safety, Skills, Management, Leadership, Corporate)
 - Second level: Program/course folders
 - Third level: Module folders containing source files, SCORM packages, supporting materials
 - Parallel structure: `\_Templates`, `\_Archive`, `\_In-Review` workflow folders
 - Clear separation between authoring workspace, review/approval staging, and published content
- Permissions Model — role-based access control mapped to the content lifecycle:
 - Authors: create and edit in authoring workspace

- Reviewers: access review/approval staging, provide feedback
- Approvers: promote content from staging to published
- Consumers: read-only access to published content via Canvas
- Admins: full access, archival, and retirement permissions
- Content Lifecycle Workflow — how a piece of training moves through six stages: Draft → Review → Approved → Published → Active → Archived. Defines ownership at each stage, review cadence (annual minimum), version control rules, and retirement criteria.
- Migration Strategy — a phased approach for absorbing existing shadow L&D content and GiANT materials into the new structure without disrupting current operations. New content goes into the system immediately; legacy content is triaged and migrated in priority order.

How This Connects to Canvas:

The information architecture in Google Drive is the authoring and governance layer. Canvas is the delivery layer. SCORM packages built from source materials in Google Drive are published to Canvas, where learners interact with them. Completion data flows back from Canvas into dashboards. The naming conventions and folder structure ensure that the connection between source files and deployed packages is always traceable.

Document Workflow Standard:

All project and training documents follow a three-stage lifecycle:

1. **Markdown (Source of Truth)** — every document starts and is retained as a `.md` file. Markdown is the canonical version; all substantive edits happen here first. Files follow the naming convention `Document-Title_v{Major}.{Minor}.md`.
2. **Google Doc (Collaboration & Approval)** — when ready for stakeholder review, a Google Doc is created from the markdown source. Collaborators comment, suggest, and approve in Google Docs. Accepted changes are reconciled back to markdown.
3. **PDF (Distribution)** — approved documents are exported as PDF for read-only distribution to the broader organization.

Every document includes the filename and version in its footer, and a final-page revision history tracking date, version, author, and changes.

1.3 — Technology Stack & Canvas Setup (Weeks 4–8)

Deliverables:

- Canvas LMS Configuration Plan — course hierarchy that mirrors the curriculum architecture (domain → program → module), enrollment groups mapped to organizational roles, branding aligned with HC identity
- SCORM Packaging Standards — templates, build specifications, and quality checklist for all interactive training content
- Integration Architecture — how Canvas connects to Google Workspace, how completion data flows to dashboards, how the data analytics team will consume training metrics
- Skills Matrix v1 (Schema) — define the data model for tracking skills per person, per role, per project — this becomes the foundation for the performance dashboards and mobile team assembly vision
- Automation Opportunities — identify workflows that can be automated via GitHub Actions, Google Apps Script, or Gemini: package builds, enrollment syncing, completion reporting, content review reminders

1.4 — Change Management Framework (Weeks 2–8)

Running in parallel with all other Phase 1 work.

Deliverables:

- Three-Tier Change Management Plan:
 - Tier 1 (Top-Down Vision): Communication package for VP and senior leadership — what is changing, why, and what the future state looks like
 - Tier 2 (Six-Month Transition): Detailed operational plan for the March–August transition — what happens to GiANT content, when new systems come online, who is responsible for what
 - Tier 3 (Workforce Empowerment): Identify 2–3 high-value, high-visibility training needs to address first, demonstrating that the new system delivers immediate value
- Stakeholder Communication Calendar — who hears what, when, and from whom

Phase 2: Design, Build & Deploy (May–August 2026)

Capacity: 20 hours/week

The first week of Phase 2 (May 4–8) is dedicated to finalizing the GiANT audit deliverables and presenting findings. Build work begins the second week (May 11) with priorities informed by the audit's retain/replace/retire recommendations.

2.1 — First-Year Onboarding Experience (Mid-May–June)

The most visible gap and the highest-value early deliverable. Nothing exists today.

Deliverables:

- Onboarding Curriculum (SCORM packages deployed to Canvas):
 - Company orientation (history, values, structure, culture)
 - Safety fundamentals (mandated training, site protocols)
 - Role-specific technical foundations
 - Tools & systems orientation (how to use what HC uses)
 - 30/60/90-day milestone check-ins with structured reflection
- Manager's Onboarding Guide — what the new hire's supervisor needs to do at each stage
- Onboarding Dashboard — tracking completion and time-to-productivity metrics

2.2 — Project Readiness Program (June–July)

The second user story from discovery — an interactive experience for when someone joins a new project.

Deliverables:

- Project Ingestion Template (SCORM-based interactive):
 - Project scope and specifications overview
 - Site-specific safety requirements
 - Team structure and communication protocols
 - Equipment and material logistics
 - Quality standards and inspection procedures
- Configurable Framework — so project managers can populate project-specific content into the template without needing instructional design skills

2.3 — Leadership Development System (June–August)

Replacing GiANT with HC's own leadership development program, informed by the Phase 1 audit.

Deliverables:

- Leadership curriculum (SCORM packages) covering:
 - Concepts retained and evolved from GiANT (repackaged in HC's voice)
 - New content addressing HC-specific leadership challenges at scale
 - Scenario-based learning modules for management development (role-playing exercises)
 - Spaced repetition system for reinforcing foundational principles
- Coaching Transition Plan — how existing coaching relationships shift from GiANT-facilitated to internally supported

2.4 — Skills Matrix & Performance Dashboards (July–August)

Deliverables:

- Skills Matrix v2 (Populated) — working system with real data for at least one division as proof of concept
- Performance Dashboard — visualization of training completion, skills coverage, and gaps by team/project/role
- Integration with the data analytics team (Cole Fleishour / Dane Macrides) for ongoing maintenance and expansion

2.5 — Shadow L&D Consolidation (Ongoing through August)

Deliverables:

- Inventory of all existing informal/shadow training across the organization
- Migration plan for valuable shadow content into the formal system
- Retirement plan for redundant or conflicting materials
- Guidelines for how individuals can contribute content through the proper workflow going forward

L&D Organization Recommendation

Based on the March 13 discussion, the recommended structure for an internal L&D function:

Role	Responsibility	Profile
VP of Learning & Development / CLO	Strategy, stakeholder management, curriculum direction	Senior leader, reports to COO or HR
Instructional Designer (×2)	Content development, delivery, relationship management	"People who can think and follow instructions" — relationship-oriented, not SCORM-technical

The technology layer (SCORM packaging, Canvas administration, automation) is handled through the systems and workflows Vanderpool Consulting builds during this engagement, supplemented by the existing IT and data analytics teams.

Technology Stack

Tool	Purpose
Canvas LMS	Course delivery, enrollment, completion tracking
SCORM 1.2	Package format for all interactive training content
Google Workspace	Content authoring, collaboration, document management
Google Drive	Information architecture, folder structure, permissions
Gemini	AI-assisted content development and review
NotebookLM	Knowledge base and reference material organization
GitHub	Version control for SCORM source files, automation scripts

Risk Register

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
GiANT content is more embedded than expected	Transition timeline compressed	Prioritize audit in weeks 1–4; identify critical dependencies early
Shadow L&D owners resist centralization	Political friction, adoption resistance	Frame as empowerment ("your content gets wider reach and proper support"), not control
Canvas adoption is slow	Low engagement with new system	Launch with high-value content first (onboarding, project readiness) so first experience is useful
Skills matrix data is incomplete or inconsistent	Dashboard is unreliable	Start with one division as pilot, prove the model, then scale
Rapid hiring outpaces training capacity	New hires arrive faster than content is built	Onboarding program is first priority for exactly this reason

Immediate Next Steps (Week of March 16)

1. Schedule GiANT audit kickoff with Jessica Hart — request access to all GiANT materials, licenses, and delivery schedules
2. Schedule discovery session with Eric Ward — shared services infrastructure, IT capabilities, data analytics team capacity
3. Request access to any existing training materials (formal or informal) across the organization
4. Begin drafting naming convention and folder structure proposal
5. Set up project workspace (Google Drive folder structure for Vanderpool ↔ HC collaboration)

Revision History

Date	Version	Author	Changes
2026-03-15	0.1	M. Vanderpool	Initial draft — engagement summary, two-phase structure, GiANT audit plan, curriculum and information architecture, technology stack, change management framework, risk register, L&D org recommendation
2026-03-15	0.2	M. Vanderpool	Revised GiANT audit timeline to span full Phase 1 (Weeks 1–7 at 5 hrs/week) + wrap-up in first 20 hr/week (Week 8, May 4–8); updated section 1.1, Phase 2 intro, and document workflow standard